

Nokia's budget offering

Nokia Launches First Dual SIM Phone The C1:
<http://bit.ly/csJzXq>

N8 coming soon

Symbian 3 Powered Power House, Nokia N8 To
 Hit Stores Soon: <http://bit.ly/9Dz8uw>

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UNDERSTANDING WARRANTY FOR YOUR PEACE OF MIND

After receiving his pay hike, Balvinder, a High Court employee felt it was prudent to fulfil his wife's long standing desire for a front loading washing machine. He was quite meticulous in finding the best deal possible. Eventually, the shop owner persuaded the couple to buy a lesser known brand with a five-year guarantee that covered fault and damage of all sorts. A year, the product started giving way.

That began the game of passing the buck. The seller would say it's the company's responsibility to offer guarantee and their only job was to sell the product. The only help rendered by the seller in this matter was providing the service centre's helpline number. To add to their woes, the couple realised their warranty was over as it was only for one year! The only option left was to approach the consumer court for action against the company and the seller. This is not an isolated case.

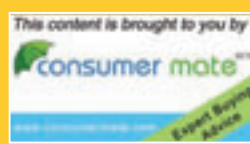
In recent times, guarantees and warranties have emerged as a safeguard to consumer rights. By means of a guarantee or warranty, the seller or service provider is liable to replace or repair the product or service provided, if it is below the expectation of the benchmark. Normally, this is a promise made by the manufacturer to the customer for a fixed time frame.

Although similar, in commercial parlance and legal practice, especially in the consumer law arena these are two different concepts with a slight difference. While guarantee refers to the post sale stand of a seller or service provider in the capacity of a guarantor. In the event of any fault or malfunction with the product or service, the onus will be on the company to sort matters out. Consumers can seek a replacement of the product or service. Generally, it is believed that one can get hold

expecting the benefit of such condition. Another term you need to be aware of is that of express and implied guarantees. An express guarantee which is a clear import of the product purchased. A television is a good example. The picture and sound of television has to be good, which is an express implication or warranty. However, if consumer needs to have television for his restaurant requiring a minimum continuous functioning of 13 to 14 hours a day, then it is the duty of the seller to provide accurate information regarding the consumer's warranty rights. Another example is if someone buys sports shoes, there is an implied warranty that it will go good for rough terrain and tough use.

Unless the shopkeeper gives you something in writing, do not assume you have any warranty or guarantee. Make sure you have in your possession documents such as bill and warranty cards. For the sake of convenience, make it a habit to write the important dates when the warranty or guarantee of your product is to going to end. The best way is to call the company people to check all the things a month before when it actually ends. If a particular problem recurs, then keep the details of the complaint. One can make a good case of the getting the things repaired if the problem was the recurring and inherent in the product even after the warranty or guarantee expires.

Another trait which has been commonly found in Indian customers is that once they've got a good deal, they don't think about the other aspects. They generally do not get the warranty document stamped and signed which is very common requirement for most products. So the next time you purchase anything, grill them rather than merely concentrating on price. 



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of their money back simply because they have a guarantee. Warranty, on the other hand, implies the provision of getting the article repaired when the product is defective. However, the recent commercial trend is the use of the word limited warranty that puts conditions on the specifics of a product, the nature of damage incurred and the time period of the validity of the document. Consequently, the prospect in a warranty is abridged by the expression "limited". Therefore there is a distinction in the real meaning and strength of guarantee and warranty which consumer must appreciate before

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